

DMD201D: AI for Business Leaders

Session 5 Hackathon Plan

Date: July 16, 2026

Time: 9:00 AM-5:00 PM

Lunch: 12:15-1:45 PM

Team size: Four or five students

Theme: Propose, build, test, and recommend an agentic AI application

Hackathon Overview

Teams spend the day designing and building an agentic AI application for a clearly defined business problem. Replit is provided as the standard development platform. Teams may instead use resources such as Claude Code or Codex, provided they can demonstrate and explain their work and comply with course data-handling requirements.

A functioning minimum viable product is ideal. When real functionality is not feasible within the available time, a polished and technically credible mockup is acceptable. Every team must still provide evaluation evidence, explain governance decisions, and make a business recommendation.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the hackathon, teams should be able to:

1. Define a narrow business problem and realistic user workflow for an agentic AI application.
2. Build and demonstrate a proof of concept, or a polished and technically credible mockup when live functionality is not feasible.
3. Evaluate the solution with representative tests and explain what succeeded, what failed, and why.
4. Identify data, safety, governance, human-oversight, implementation, and cost considerations.
5. Make a clear business recommendation: proceed, revise and retest, or do not proceed.

Required Team Outputs

- A concise final proposal submitted by 9:30 AM.
- A working MVP or polished mockup showing the intended user journey and agentic workflow.
- Evaluation evidence from at least five representative test cases, including at least one difficult or failure case.

- A brief record of key governance decisions, including data use, human approval boundaries, and important risks.
- A short presentation deck and live demonstration or guided mockup walkthrough.
- A business recommendation and practical next step.

Schedule

Time	Activity	Focus and Output
9:00-9:30	Kickoff and proposal finalization	Review the day, finalize team roles and project scope, and submit the proposal by 9:30 AM.
9:30-12:15	Build	Develop the core user journey and agentic workflow in Replit or another chosen environment. Aim for a working MVP; maintain a polished mockup as the fallback when live functionality is not feasible.
12:15-1:45	Lunch	Lunch break. No work is required.
1:45-2:20	Test and refine	Run at least five representative tests, document results and one important failure case, and make final improvements.
2:20-3:00	Prepare presentations	Complete the slides, stabilize the demonstration, document governance decisions, make the business recommendation, and rehearse.
3:00-4:40	Team presentations	Ten 10-minute slots: 7 minutes to present and demonstrate, 2 minutes for Q&A, and 1 minute for transition.
4:40-5:00	Feedback and close	Review common lessons, submit final links and materials, and identify the most important next step for the project.

Proposal Checkpoint

The proposal should fit on one page or one slide and include:

- Project title, team members, and primary user.
- Business problem and why it matters.
- Proposed agentic workflow: what the AI observes, decides, produces, or does.
- Minimum proof of concept to be demonstrated by 3:00 PM.
- Intended data or knowledge sources, using only public, synthetic, or approved data.
- Success criteria and planned test cases.
- Main foreseeable risk and human-oversight boundary.

Approval at the checkpoint confirms that the project is appropriately scoped; it does not guarantee that the proposed approach will receive a high grade. Teams may narrow their scope after the checkpoint but should explain major changes in the presentation.

Suggested Team Roles

Teams may combine or rotate roles, but all members should understand the complete solution.

- **Product and workflow lead:** Protects the problem definition, user journey, and business recommendation.
- **Build lead:** Coordinates the Replit project or other implementation environment and maintains the stable demo version.
- **AI workflow lead:** Develops prompts, context, tools, and agent behavior.
- **Evaluation and governance lead:** Prepares tests, captures results, and documents risks and approval boundaries.
- **Presentation lead:** Assembles the deck, coordinates the demonstration, and manages timing.

MVP and Mockup Policy

A functioning MVP is preferred because it provides stronger evidence about feasibility and behavior. When real functionality is not feasible within the available time, a polished mockup is acceptable.

A mockup should still:

- Demonstrate the complete user journey.
- Make proposed agent actions and decision points explicit.
- Use realistic example inputs and outputs.
- Explain credibly how missing functionality would be implemented and tested.

Visual polish alone is not evidence of technical or business viability.

Presentation Format

Each team receives a fixed 10-minute slot:

- **7 minutes:** Problem, proposed workflow, demonstration, evaluation evidence, governance choices, and recommendation.
- **2 minutes:** One or two focused questions from the facilitator or judges.
- **1 minute:** Transition to the next team.

A recommended deck is five to seven slides:

1. Business problem and primary user.
2. Proposed workflow.

3. MVP or mockup demonstration.
4. Evaluation evidence.
5. Governance decisions and limitations.
6. Business recommendation and next step.

For ten teams, the facilitator should publish the presentation order before lunch and use a visible timer.

Grading Rubric

The hackathon project is graded out of 100 points. The app or prototype accounts for 70 points and the presentation accounts for 30 points.

Component	Criterion	Points	Full-Credit Evidence
App / prototype	Business problem and scope	10	Identifies a specific user, consequential problem, current workflow, and measurable success claim; scope is achievable and coherent.
App / prototype	Agentic workflow design	15	Clearly shows what the AI observes, reasons about, decides, produces, or acts on; tools, context, and human handoffs fit the task.
App / prototype	Functionality or prototype fidelity	20	A working MVP completes the core path reliably, or a polished mockup demonstrates the full interaction and agent logic with a credible implementation plan.
App / prototype	Evaluation evidence	15	Uses at least five relevant tests, reports observed results, includes a difficult or failure case, and draws a justified conclusion rather than relying on a single successful demo.
App / prototype	Governance and implementation realism	10	Addresses data use, privacy or security as relevant, human approval boundaries, failure handling, operational ownership, and major cost or feasibility constraints.
Presentation	Problem-to-demo narrative	10	Clearly connects the business problem, user, workflow, and demonstration within the time limit.
Presentation	Evidence and limitations	8	Explains evaluation results, important limitations, and what remains unproven with appropriate candor.
Presentation	Business recommendation	7	Makes a defensible proceed, revise and retest, or do-not-proceed recommendation with a concrete next step.
Presentation	Delivery and Q&A	5	Shares speaking responsibility appropriately, uses readable materials, stays within seven minutes, and answers questions directly.
Total		100	

Performance Guide

Level	General Standard
Excellent	Specific, coherent, and evidence-based. The core workflow is convincing, risks and limits are handled honestly, and the recommendation follows from the results.
Good	The main workflow and business case are clear, with useful evidence and reasonable governance decisions, but some assumptions or implementation details remain underdeveloped.
Developing	The concept is understandable but scope, workflow logic, evidence, or governance is incomplete; claims exceed what the prototype or tests demonstrate.
Insufficient	The project lacks a coherent business problem or demonstrable workflow, provides little evaluation evidence, or ignores material risks and implementation constraints.

Final Submission Checklist

- Final proposal.

- Replit project, other application link, or mockup link.
- Slide deck.
- Evaluation evidence.
- Governance decisions and human-oversight boundary.
- Business recommendation and next step.